Leave and Absence Policy

Arbeitszeit, Urlaub und Freistellung – Working Hours, Vacation and Leave

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Consulted	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat); Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel and Data Protection Officer; Dr. Sabine Lang, company physician (Betriebsärztin)
Applies to	All employees of Norvane Systems GmbH at all sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt)
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1 Purpose and scope

1.1 Purpose

This policy explains our provisions for working hours, vacation, public holidays, sick leave, special leave and parental leave. It forms part of the Employee Handbook (NS-HR-POL-005, section 7). Where the law or your employment contract (Arbeitsvertrag) gives you more than this policy, the law or contract applies.

1.2 Scope and overview

The policy applies to all employees, including part-time employees, working students (Werkstudenten), interns and apprentices, unless their contract says otherwise. We cover five types of leave and time off:

Type	Entitlement	Request or notify
Vacation (Urlaub)	30 days per year (five-day week)	Personio, approval by line manager
Public holidays	As per the state of your workplace	No request needed
Sick leave	Pay continued for up to 6 weeks	Notify by 09:00 on the first day; doctor's note from day 3
Special leave	Bereavement, wedding, moving, civic duties	Notify line manager; Personio entry
Parental leave	Maternity protection, partner leave, Elternzeit	HR, in good time

All absences are recorded in Personio. If you are unsure which rule applies to you, ask HR (hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000).

2 Working hours

2.1 Standard working time and flexitime

The regular working time for full-time employees is 40 hours per week. Our offices are open on weekdays from 07:00 to 19:00. Within this window you choose your start and end of day, depending on your team's needs, as long as you are available during the core hours from 10:00 to 15:00 and reach your weekly hours. Record your working time in Personio. We work hybrid, with up to 2 remote days per week (see Employee Handbook, section 6.2).

2.2 Working time models by group

Group	Weekly hours	Working time model
Office staff in Munich, Berlin and Frankfurt	40 h	Flexitime, core hours 10:00-15:00, building open 07:00-19:00
Garching early shift	40 h	06:00-14:30, including a 30-minute unpaid break
Garching late shift	40 h	14:00-22:30, including a 30-minute unpaid break
Customer Support (service desk)	40 h	Rota between 07:00 and 19:00, published 2 weeks in advance by Hannah Schulz's team
Frankfurt data center operations	40 h	Day work plus a weekly rotating on-call duty (Rufbereitschaft) for out-of-hours incidents

2.3 Shifts, after-hours work and on-call duty

Some departments work outside the regular hours, for example customer support, device staging and shipping in Garching, and data center operations. If you work in these departments, you follow a shift or on-call schedule. Shift plans are published at least 2 weeks in advance. Shift swaps are agreed with your shift lead at least 48 hours in advance and recorded in Personio. On-call duty and its compensation are regulated in your contract and in the agreement with the Works Council (Betriebsrat).

2.4 Breaks and rest periods

We follow the Working Time Act (Arbeitszeitgesetz): you take a break of at least 30 minutes if you work more than 6 hours and 45 minutes if you work more than 9 hours. You work no more than 10 hours per day and have at least 11 hours of rest between two working days. After an on-call call-out the rest period must be respected, and your start time the next day is adjusted accordingly.

2.5 Flexitime account and overtime

Balance	Rule
Up to +40 hours	Free to use; take time off in agreement with your team
+40 to +60 hours	You and your line manager agree a plan to reduce the balance within 3 months
Above +60 hours	Not credited without prior written approval by your line manager
Below -20 hours	Discuss with your line manager; the balance should be brought back to zero within 2 months

Overtime must be ordered or approved in advance. It is compensated by time off in lieu and is not paid out unless your contract or the law says otherwise.

3 Vacation

3.1 Entitlement

You are entitled to 30 days of vacation (Urlaub) per calendar year, based on a five-day working week, in addition to public holidays. This includes the statutory minimum under the Federal Vacation Act (Bundesurlaubsgesetz, BUrlG). For part-time employees the number of days is adjusted to the number of working days per week.

3.2 Accrual and first year

Vacation accrues at 2.5 days per month, from the day you join. After your first week with us you can take the days you have accrued. If you need more days than you have accrued, you may take them in advance with the approval of your line manager and HR. If you join or leave during the year, you receive the part of the entitlement that corresponds to your months of employment. The legal entitlement to full annual leave arises after 6 months of employment (Wartezeit); our approach to advance leave in the first months is more generous.

3.3 How to request vacation

Send a vacation request through Personio. You do not have to give a reason. Your line manager approves or declines the request within 5 working days. A request is declined only for operational reasons or because other employees' requests have priority for social reasons, for example parents during school holidays. For vacation of more than 5 working days, please submit the request at least 2 weeks in

advance. We encourage you to take at least 10 consecutive days once a year and to use your time off throughout the year. Religious holidays that are not public holidays can be taken as vacation days or, by agreement, as unpaid leave.

If you fall ill during your vacation and submit a doctor's note, the days of illness are not counted as vacation.

3.4 Carry-over

Remaining vacation is carried over to the following year and must be taken by 31 March. HR reminds you and your line manager every October, so that you can plan to take your remaining days. If you could not take your vacation because of illness or operational reasons, speak to HR; the legal rules on the expiry of leave apply.

3.5 Leaving the company

If you leave Norvane Systems, we try to schedule your remaining vacation before the last working day. If this is not possible, the remaining days are paid out (Urlaubsabgeltung) in accordance with the BUrlG with your final salary. If you have taken more vacation than you have accrued by your leaving date, we do not recover the difference for days within the statutory minimum.

4 Public holidays

4.1 Holidays we observe

We observe the public holidays of the federal state where your workplace is located: Bavaria for Munich HQ and the Garching depot, Berlin for the Berlin office and Hesse for the Frankfurt data center. Employees who work remotely follow the state of their contractual place of work.

Holiday	Date	Munich / Garching	Berlin	Frankfurt
New Year's Day (Neujahr)	01.01.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Epiphany (Heilige Drei Könige)	06.01.	Yes	–	–
International Women's Day	08.03.	–	Yes	–
Good Friday (Karfreitag)	varies	Yes	Yes	Yes
Easter Monday (Ostermontag)	varies	Yes	Yes	Yes
Labour Day (Tag der Arbeit)	01.05.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Ascension Day (Christi Himmelfahrt)	varies	Yes	Yes	Yes
Whit Monday (Pfingstmontag)	varies	Yes	Yes	Yes
Corpus Christi (Fronleichnam)	varies	Yes	–	Yes
Assumption Day (Mariä Himmelfahrt)	15.08.	Yes	–	–
German Unity Day (Tag der Deutschen Einheit)	03.10.	Yes	Yes	Yes
All Saints' Day (Allerheiligen)	01.11.	Yes	–	–
Christmas Day (1. Weihnachtstag)	25.12.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Boxing Day (2. Weihnachtstag)	26.12.	Yes	Yes	Yes
Number of holidays		**13**	**10**	**10**

Assumption Day is also observed at the Garching depot. A holiday that falls on a Saturday or Sunday is not made up on another day. 24.12. and 31.12. are normal working days; you can take vacation for them.

4.2 Holiday pay

All employees receive their normal pay for public holidays, with no deduction. This applies from the first day of employment. Working students and part-time employees are paid for the holidays that fall on their regular working days.

4.3 Working on a public holiday

Public holidays are non-working days for most employees. Work on a holiday is allowed only where the law permits it, for example for data center operations, on-call duty and customer-critical incidents. If we need you to work on a public holiday, we inform you at least 3 working days in advance, except for incidents. You receive time off in lieu, which you must take within 12 months, and any supplement agreed in your contract or with the Works Council. Hours worked on a holiday count towards your weekly hours and your flexitime account.

5 Sick leave

5.1 Notification and certificate

If you are unable to work because of illness, injury or other incapacity, you receive your pay for up to 6 weeks per illness, in accordance with the Continued Remuneration Act (Entgeltfortzahlungsgesetz, EFZG). Short-term illness, injuries and mental health issues are treated the same way. If you have the flu or another contagious disease, please stay at home and use your sick days.

When	What you do	Who
First day of illness, by 09:00 (Garching shifts: 30 minutes before the shift)	Inform your line manager and hr@norvane.example by phone or message, with the expected duration	You
From the third calendar day of illness	Visit a doctor and submit the certificate of incapacity (ärztliche Arbeitsunfähigkeitsbescheinigung); we may ask for it earlier	You
Throughout	For statutory health insurance, the certificate is retrieved electronically; privately insured employees send the paper note to HR	HR
End of illness or extension	Inform your line manager and HR; the sick days are recorded in Personio	You, HR

Medical diagnoses are never passed on to line managers. Health data are processed under NS-LEG-POL-001. If you feel able to work part of the day, agree this with your line manager. We advise you to rest and recover for a day before returning to work.

5.2 Medical appointments and sick children

Please schedule routine appointments (doctor, dentist) outside core hours where possible, or use your flexitime. If appointments cannot be scheduled outside working time, discuss it with your line manager. If your child is ill, you can take statutory child sick days (Kinderkrankentage), for which the health insurance pays a benefit; notify HR and submit the doctor's certificate for the child.

5.3 Long-term illness and return to work

After the 6 weeks of continued pay, the statutory health insurance pays sickness benefit (Krankengeld) for up to 78 weeks within three years for the same illness. If you are absent for more than 6 weeks within 12 months, HR will offer you a conversation about reintegration (betriebliches Eingliederungsmanagement). Participation is voluntary. You can bring a person you trust, and the Works Council (Betriebsrat) and, if you wish, the company physician Dr. Sabine Lang can be involved. Options include a gradual return (stufenweise Wiedereingliederung), adjusted tasks and ergonomic changes. Please contact HR for more information when needed.

6 Special leave

6.1 Bereavement leave

Losing a loved one is a very difficult experience. If this happens to you while you work with us, we want to support you and give you time to cope and mourn. For this reason, we offer paid bereavement leave for the following purposes, on consecutive or non-consecutive days within 4 weeks of the death:

- Arranging a funeral or memorial service.
- Attending a funeral or memorial service.
- Resolving matters of inheritance.
- Fulfilling other family obligations.
- Mourning.

Occasion	Paid leave	Proof
Death of a partner, child, parent or sibling	2 working days	Notification to line manager
Death of other close relatives	1 working day	Notification to line manager
Long-distance travel for the funeral (more than 400 km one way)	Up to 2 additional unpaid days	Notification to line manager
Own wedding or registered partnership	1 working day	Marriage certificate
Moving house (employer-initiated)	1 working day	Notification

If you need more time, please use your vacation or speak to HR in confidence. The Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) is also available (eap@norvane.example, ext. 2010).

6.2 Civic duties and voting

If you are summoned as a witness, lay judge (Schöffe) or for another civic duty that cannot be done outside working hours, you are released for the time needed, without loss of pay. Where the law gives you more, we follow the law. Please inform your line manager as soon as you receive the summons, and give HR a copy of the summons and a confirmation of attendance. Elections in Germany usually take place on Sundays, so no leave is needed for voting. If you act as a polling-station volunteer (Wahlhelfer), you are released on the day.

7 Parental leave

Caring for a newborn is an exciting time for parents. We support new mothers and fathers in the first months of parenthood and afterwards with flexible working options. Talk to HR as soon as you know about the expected date, and in confidence if you wish.

7.1 Maternity protection (Mutterschutz)

Expectant mothers are protected by the Maternity Protection Act (Mutterschutzgesetz). The protection period begins 6 weeks before the expected birth and lasts 8 weeks after the birth (12 weeks after premature or multiple births). During this period you receive maternity benefit (Mutterschaftsgeld) from your health insurance, and we pay a supplement up to your previous net salary. If you suffer complications or have other health issues, you can ask for an unpaid leave extension of up to 2 months. Contact HR as soon as possible.

7.2 Partner leave

Fathers and other partners of the birth mother receive 10 working days of paid partner leave, which must be taken within 8 weeks after the birth. The same applies to the placement of an adopted child. Please inform HR at least 3 months before the expected date where possible.

7.3 Parental leave (Elternzeit)

Both parents are entitled to statutory parental leave (Elternzeit) of up to 3 years per child, including adoption. Submit your request in writing to HR at least 7 weeks before it begins; we ask you to inform us 3 months in advance if possible so that we can plan the replacement. During Elternzeit you can work part-time as provided by law, and you have special protection against termination. HR explains your options and the parental allowance (Elterngeld) procedure, which is paid by the state and not by Norvane Systems.

7.4 Returning to work after parental leave

We are committed to helping new parents return to work. HR and your line manager hold a return conversation about 4 weeks before your return. We offer:

- Hybrid working with up to 2 remote days per week, flexible start and end of the working day within the core hours, and part-time options.
- Advice from HR on childcare places (Kita) near our sites. We do not operate our own childcare facility.
- A quiet room for nursing mothers at Munich HQ and at the Berlin office.
- Release of up to 4 hours for school or kindergarten events, such as enrolment and parent-teacher meetings, on agreement with your line manager.

8 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
Leave, absences, general HR questions	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
Policy owner	Julia Neumann, HR Director	julia.neumann@norvane.example	2001
Contracts, payroll, parental leave	Jordan Ellis, HR Generalist	jordan.ellis@norvane.example	2020
Counselling (EAP), return to work	Mariam Haddad	eap@norvane.example	2010
Occupational health	Dr. Sabine Lang (Tuesdays, HQ)	sabine.lang@norvane.example	2450
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	Thomas Bauer	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Personio access	Helpdesk	helpdesk@norvane.example	3000

9 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-001	Code of Conduct	Attendance and conduct
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies (v2.1, effective 01.01.2026)	Health and safety, remote work
NS-HR-POL-005	Employee Handbook – Overview and Introduction	Section 7 summarises this policy
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Handling of health data

10 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	01.07.2023	Julia Neumann	First issue
1.1	01.03.2025	Jordan Ellis	Added flexitime account rules and Garching shift swaps
2.0	01.01.2026	Julia Neumann	Revised vacation carry-over, special leave and partner leave; aligned with Employee Handbook v1.2

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